CSE0001 – Digital Literacy

Project Report

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Introduction

This report is submitted as part of the CSE0001 Digital Literacy course at VIT Bhopal University. The project scenario places me in the role of a Student Digital Ambassador, responsible for helping peers navigate the digital world safely and professionally. To fulfil this role, I completed five tasks covering key digital skills across five course modules.

The tasks include creating a digital literacy awareness infographic, building a professional online presence, exploring coding and collaboration platforms, drafting professional emails, and researching cybercrime. All completed work is organised in a public GitHub repository at github.com/Adikundliya/Digital-Literacy-Project-25BAI10634. This report documents the approach taken in each task, the tools used, and personal reflections on what was learnt.

Task 1 – Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For Task 1, I created a one-page Digital Literacy Awareness infographic for my batchmates using Canva, saved in the task-1-presentation/ folder. Canva is a free, browser-based design tool with ready-made templates and layout options, which made it straightforward to produce a visually engaging design without prior graphic design experience.

The infographic covers four sections. The first defines digital literacy as the ability to find, evaluate, create, and communicate information using digital technologies safely and effectively. The second covers safe internet practices, including using strong unique passwords with 2FA, spotting phishing links, only using HTTPS-encrypted sites, and thinking before sharing or clicking. The third highlights useful digital tools for students such as Notion, Google Docs, Canva, Google Slides, Google Scholar, Zotero, Trello, and Todoist. The fourth section focuses on email etiquette — covering how to write a proper subject line, open with a formal greeting, state your purpose clearly, and sign off professionally.

What I found most interesting while making this was realising how interconnected these four areas are. Good digital literacy is not just one skill — it is a combination of safety awareness, effective communication, and the right use of tools working together.

Task 2 – Student Digital Portfolio

For Task 2, I set up professional profiles on three platforms — GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle — with screenshots saved in the task-2-portfolio/ folder.

GitHub is used for hosting and sharing code projects. I created a profile README under the username Adikundliya, which includes my name, branch, year, and a short note on what I hope to learn during my B.Tech. This Digital Literacy repository is already part of my GitHub portfolio. LinkedIn is the leading professional networking platform used by employers and internship coordinators globally. I filled in my Education section with my current degree, institution, and expected graduation year. Kaggle is a data science and machine learning community where students can practise coding and participate in competitions — directly relevant to my Artificial Intelligence branch.

Over the next four years, I plan to use GitHub to document all my projects, LinkedIn to build professional connections and apply for internships, and Kaggle to sharpen my machine learning skills alongside coursework. Setting these up in the first semester felt like an important early investment in my digital identity.

Task 3 – Coding Platforms & Google Workspace Collaboration

For Task 3, I explored two categories of tools: a coding practice platform and a cloud collaboration tool. All screenshots and notes are saved in the task-3-platforms/ folder.

For the coding component, I created an account on HackerRank and completed the Python Introduction challenge. HackerRank provides an in-browser code editor with

automated test cases, making it easy to practise without any local setup. A screenshot of the completed challenge and score has been saved as proof. For the collaboration component, I created a Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz using Google Forms with five questions — including a multiple choice and a short answer question — designed to test batchmates on digital safety and email etiquette. The form is linked to a Google Sheet that tracks responses in real time. The form link will be added to the README before final submission.

HackerRank will help me build consistent coding habits with instant feedback. Google Forms and Sheets are practical for collaborative coursework, surveys, and peer feedback — skills I will need throughout my degree.

Task 4 – Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

For Task 4, I drafted two professional emails and a Social Media Do's and Don'ts checklist, all saved in the task-4-email-etiqutte/ folder. The first email was a request from a student to a professor for a deadline extension. The second expressed interest in a summer internship opportunity. Both follow proper email structure: a clear subject line, a formal greeting, a well-organised body, and a professional sign-off. The social media checklist is saved separately as social-media-checklist.md.

One situation where poor digital communication caused a real problem is when students send casual, unstructured emails to professors with no subject line, no greeting, and no context. These are frequently ignored or leave a poor impression. The fix is simple — a clear subject, a formal address, a brief reason, and a polite close. A short, well-written email always scores higher than a long, poorly structured one.

Task 5 – Cybercrime Awareness: UPI / Online Payment Fraud

For Task 5, I researched UPI and Online Payment Fraud — one of the most common cybercrimes affecting college students in India. I wrote a case study saved as casestudy.md covering how this fraud works, who is targeted, and the consequences.

I also created a ‘Stay Safe Online’ checklist saved as prevention-checklist.md, with eight actionable tips including two specific to UPI safety and references to cybercrime.gov.in and Helpline 1930.

What surprised me most was how psychologically sophisticated these scams are. UPI fraud does not involve hacking — it relies entirely on social engineering. Victims are manipulated into approving payment requests while believing they are receiving money. By the time they realise, recovery is nearly impossible. One habit I will personally change is to never approve a UPI request from an unknown contact, no matter how convincing the story sounds.

Conclusion

This project has been a practical and eye-opening experience. Across five tasks, I developed skills that go well beyond a typical first-semester classroom — from building a professional digital presence on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle, to understanding how cybercriminals psychologically manipulate victims. The most important takeaway is that digital literacy is an ongoing practice, not a one-time task. Communicating professionally, coding consistently, staying alert online, and maintaining credible profiles are habits that will serve me throughout my B.Tech and beyond. I feel genuinely better prepared to navigate the digital world responsibly after completing this project.

References

- Canva – canva.com
- GitHub – github.com
- LinkedIn – linkedin.com
- Kaggle – kaggle.com
- HackerRank – hackerrank.com
- Google Forms – forms.google.com

- National Cyber Crime Portal – cybercrime.gov.in
- Cyber Crime Helpline – 1930 (24x7, Government of India)
- CSE0001 Digital Literacy – Project Assignment Brief, VIT Bhopal University